Information and explanation about the survey

Name of the Survey: Research of rural shrinkage and resilience

In the survey study, it was aimed to determine the reasons of rural shrinkage in …. and …. districts, which show different development characteristics, by the experts living in the region (provincial and district municipal employees, NGOs, associations, chambers, local initiatives, etc.).

Shrinkage in rural areas or villages was defined by the problems such as migration and decrease in population size, aging, decrease in local productivity, increase in unemployment rates, inability to access to social services and decrease in the quality of life.

In the questionnaire, the factors causing the rural shrinkage were asked separately in three different dimensions: social, economic and ecological, and in three different administrative scales: macro …. region, mezzo ….. counties and micro settlements/villages of counties/districts.

The survey consists of thirty-five (36) questions and can be completed in about 15-20 minutes.

Your participation in the survey is kindly requested and participation in this study is entirely voluntary. You can participate in the questionnaire by Google forms via internet.

Your personal information will not be requested within the scope of the survey. The results obtained will be used only in the scope of the thesis and in the publications to be produced from the thesis.

You can share the questionnaire with third parties that you think may be relevant. Thus, it will make an important contribution to the study.

1- General Information

1. Your age
2. Your job
3. Place of residence (Neighborhood or Village)
4. Place of Work (Neighborhood or Village)

2- Questions about rural shrinkage

5. Which region will you be responding to the survey for? *(Mark only one oval)*

   - ….. district
   - ….. district
   - Other

6. Since when do you live in …..? (Mark only one oval)

- ⬭ Between 1-5 years
- ⬭ Between 5-10 years
- ⬭ Between 10-20 years
- ⬭ More than 20 years

7. How do you think the level of development in the villages of ….. district changes compared to the past? (Mark only one oval)

- ⬭ Better than before
- ⬭ No change
- ⬭ Getting worse
- ⬭ No idea
- ⬭ Other

8. Since when do you think the villages of ….. district are experiencing a shrinkage?

- ⬭ Less than 1 year
- ⬭ Between 1-5 years
- ⬭ Between 5-10 years
- ⬭ Between 10-20 years
- ⬭ Between 20-50 years
- ⬭ More than 50 years
- ⬭ Other

9. According to the map below, which villages of ….. district do you think shrink? Please write their names.

3- Evaluation of factors' impacts

In this section each question should be marked according to the impact levels ranging from 0 to 4. (Mark only one oval)

- ⬭ 0 No effect
- ⬭ 1 Less effective
- ⬭ 2 Moderately effective
- ⬭ 3 Effective
- ⬭ 4 Very effective

Evaluation of macro scale factors

10. Please select the degree of effect of the SOCIAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. region.

- International migration
- Deficiencies in national - regional policies
- Changes in rural development policies
- Other reason

11. Write down any other factors you wish to add. (same options for other questions)

12. Since when you think the SOCIAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. region are effective?

13. Please select the degree of effect of the ECONOMIC factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. region.

- Lack or weakness of international transport and trade connections.
- Sparse or insufficient regional rail /public transport network
- Inadequate regional investments
- Inadequate agricultural support
- Agricultural product planning system
- Regulation of purchase and sale prices of agricultural products
- Other Reason

14. Since when do you think the ECONOMIC factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. region are effective?

15. Please select the degree of effect of the ECOLOGICAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. region.

- Global climate change
- Environmental pollution in the region
- Destruction of natural resources in the region
- Other Reason

16. Since when do you think the ECOLOGICAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. region are effective?

Evaluation of mezzo scale factors

17. Please select the degree of effect of the SOCIAL factors leading to rural shrinkage in the ….. district.

- Migration to city or district centre
- Inadequate public services or difficult access in the district
- Insufficient Health Services (Hospital, Elderly Nursing Home, etc.)
- Inadequate educational services (schools, courses, kindergartens, etc.)
- Inadequate cultural services (cinema, library, concert hall etc.)
- Other Reason

18. Since when do you think the SOCIAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. district are effective?

19. Please select the degree of effect of the ECONOMIC factors leading to rural shrinkage in the ….. district.

- Lack of adequate and varied transport connections
- Lack of sufficient and diverse enterprises and industrial zones
- Insufficient support of natural or historical tourism opportunities
- Other Reason

20. Since when do you think the ECONOMIC factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. district are effective?

21. Please select the degree of effect of the ECOLOGICAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. district.

- Lack of diversity of natural resources (wetland, forest, natural plant-animal species) in the district
- Difficulty or variability of climate conditions in the region (drought, flood etc.)
- Occurrence of natural disasters (flood-landslide-earthquake-storm-fire, etc.)
- Environmental pollution in the district
- Other Reason

22. Since when do you think the ECOLOGICAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the ….. district are effective?

Evaluation of micro scale factors

23. Please select the degree of effect of the SOCIAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the settlements/villages in ….. district.

- Out-migration
- Aging
- Weakness of social relations
- Difficulty of access to the health care services in villages
- Difficult access to education services in villages
- Difficult access to cultural services in villages
- Other Reason

24. Since when you think the SOCIAL factors that cause rural shrinkage in the settlement/villages of ….. district are effective?

25. Please select the degree of effect of the ECONOMIC factors that cause rural shrinkage in the settlements/villages in ….. district.

- Lack of sufficient and varied job opportunities
- Expensiveness
- Bad road infrastructure
- Insufficient or infrequent public transport facilities
- Insufficient electrical infrastructure
- Insufficient communication and internet access
- Inadequate irrigation infrastructure
- Inactive cooperatives and lack of support
- Other Reason

26. Since when do you think the ECONOMIC factors that cause rural shrinkage in the settlement/villages of ….. district are effective?

27. Please select the degree of effect of the ECOLOGIC factors that cause rural shrinkage in the settlements/villages in ….. district.

- Low agricultural or animal product diversity
- Diseases and pests in agricultural and animal products
- Extreme climatic events damage agricultural production (Flood, storm, drought and so on.)
- Pollutant effect of industrial plants or mining sites
- Depletion or destruction of local natural resources
- Other Reason

28. Since when do you think the ECOLOGIC factors that cause rural shrinkage in the settlement/villages of ….. district are effective?

29. Please indicate whether there are other factors that lead to rural shrinkage.

30. How long have the other factors you mentioned been causing population shrinkage in rural areas?

4. Evaluation of the administrative roles

31. For each of the institutions and organizations listed below, please mark the importance of them in terms of their impact on the prevention of rural shrinkage.

    - ◯ No importance
    - ◯ Less important
    - ◯ Moderately important
    - ◯ Important
    - ◯ Very important

- EU
- Central government
- Related Ministries (Ministry of Food and Agriculture, Ministry of Finance, Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development so on)
- Regional Administration
- Provincial Municipality
- District Municipality and organizations
- Local administration
- Educational Institutions
- Health institutions
- Private sector (Enterprises, industrial plants)
- Non-Governmental Organizations (Chamber, Association, Foundation etc.)

- Cooperatives
- Communities and Individual initiatives
- Agricultural Engineers
- Veterinarians
- Other

32. If there is any other institution or organization that you think has an effect, please write.

5. Evaluation of administrative success

33. In the context of rural shrinkage, evaluate existing social, economic and environmental governance policies between 1 and 10 (1 = failed, 10 = successful).

- Social Policies
- Economic Policy
- Ecological Policies

34. In the context of rural shrinkage, evaluate the current regional strategies (Luneburg Region) in social, economic and environmental terms between 1 and 10 (1 = failed, 10 = successful).

- Social Strategies
- Economic Strategies
- Ecological Strategies

35. In the context of rural shrinkage, evaluate the current district administration action plans (Lüneburg district) in social, economic and ecological terms between 1 and 10 (1 = failed, 10 = successful).

- Social action plans
- Economic action plans
- Ecological action plans

If you have any comments about the policies, practices developed by the current administration, please write down.

6. Evaluation of solutions importance

36. Which topics should be improved in the first place to achieve rural development?

- ◯ 0 No effect
- ◯ 1 Less effective
- ◯ 2 Moderately effective
- ◯ 3 Effective
- ◯ 4 Very effective

1. Increasing or improving education service opportunities

2. Increasing or improving health care facilities

3. Improvement of cultural facilities - library, course, cinema, theatre, concert venues

4. Establishment of innovation and entrepreneurship centres

5. Creation of a new generation of co-working spaces and production areas (3D printers)

6. Consultation for digital literacy in the villages

7. Supporting agricultural production

8. Tourism promotion and infrastructure investments

9. Supporting commercial enterprises, SMEs

10. Supporting cooperatives

11. Supporting the sharing economy

12. Establishment of common production areas in villages such as cold stores, small production facilities.

13. Broadband Internet access

14. Improvement of infrastructure (road-water) services

15. Increasing and improving public transportation facilities

16. Providing consultancy services of veterinary, agricultural or forest engineering to villages.

17. Regional use of renewable energy sources

18. Reducing and eliminating environmental problems